

System Setup

Set up your machine for building. Claude Code handles most of this for you — just follow the steps.

Step 1: Run the System Audit

This is your first real interaction with Claude Code as a tool. Copy-paste this prompt into Claude Code:

```
Check my system and tell me which of these tools are installed
and which are missing: Homebrew, Node.js, npm, npx, pnpm, and Git.
For anything missing or not on the latest version, walk me through
installing or updating it step by step.
```

Claude Code will check your system, tell you what's missing, and walk you through installing everything. Follow its instructions — it will guide you step by step.

Step 2: Verify Everything Installed

After Claude Code finishes, verify each tool is installed. You can either ask Claude Code to verify, or run these commands yourself in the VS Code terminal:

Tool	Verify Command	What You Should See
Homebrew	brew --version	A version number (e.g., Homebrew 4.x.x)
Node.js	node --version	A version number (e.g., v24.x.x)
npm	npm --version	A version number
npx	npx --version	A version number
pnpm	pnpm --version	A version number
Git	git --version	A version number (e.g., git version 2.x.x)

Or just ask Claude Code:

Verify that Homebrew, Node.js, npm, npx, pnpm, and Git are all installed and working. Show me the version of each.

Step 3: Create Your Projects Folder

Ask Claude Code:

```
Create a Projects folder in my home directory if it doesn't exist
already. Then inside it, create a folder called my-first-project.
```

This gives you a clean folder structure:

```
~/Projects/
└─ my-first-project/
```

Then open it in VS Code: **File** → **Open Folder** → **Projects** → **my-first-project**

What Each Tool Does

You don't need to understand these deeply — just know they exist and what they're for.

Tool	Plain English
Homebrew	An app store for developer tools on Mac. Installs everything else.
Node.js	The engine that runs your web apps. Most modern apps need it.
npm / npx	Install and run code libraries your project needs. Come with Node.js.
pnpm	A faster version of npm. Recommended for this course.
Git	Tracks every change you make to your code. Your "save point" system.

Full Setup Checklist

Check off each item as you complete it:

From Module 1.2 (Builder's Toolkit):

- ☐ VS Code installed
- ☐ Claude Code extension installed and signed in
- ☐ Wispr Flow installed (optional)
- ☐ GitHub account created
- ☐ Vercel account created

From this module (System Setup):

- ☐ Homebrew installed
- ☐ Node.js installed (latest version)
- ☐ npm and npx available
- ☐ pnpm installed
- ☐ Git installed
- ☐ ~/Projects folder created
- ☐ my-first-project folder created and opened in VS Code

Troubleshooting Prompts

If you run into issues, paste these into Claude Code:

Something won't install:

```
I'm having trouble installing [tool name]. Here's the error:  
[paste the error message]
```

"Command not found" error:

```
I'm getting "command not found" when I run [command].  
Help me fix it.
```

Permission error:

```
I'm getting a permission error when trying to install [tool name].  
What do I do?
```

Something feels broken:

```
I just installed [tool name] but it doesn't seem to be working.
```

Can you check if it's set up correctly?

Start over with the full check:

Check my system again and verify that Homebrew, Node.js, npm, npx, pnpm, and Git are all installed and on the latest versions.